PRICE CALCULATOR

BONUS 4



Selling-Price Calculator Guide

Price handmade seed-bead jewelry so your time counts, your costs are covered and the numbers make sense | Tiny Bead Studio

Pricing is where many lovely makers get stuck. You spend three hours on a bracelet, it looks beautiful, and then you hear yourself say that you could not possibly charge much for it. A few months later you are making more pieces, spending more on beads, and wondering why there is nothing left over.

This guide gives you a calm, repeatable way to price. It is built on one simple formula, a way to track what your beads really cost, six worked examples in US dollars, and a one-page cheat sheet. There are also blank worksheets, described as practice tasks, that you can copy into a notebook or a spreadsheet.

Two honest notes first. All the dollar figures in this guide are examples to show how the math works. They are not a promise of what your pieces will sell for or what you will earn, and your costs, time and market will be different. And fees, taxes and business rules change and vary by place, so wherever fees appear we treat them as variables and tell you to check current fees and your own state or country rules. This guide is general information, not financial, tax or legal advice.

1. Chapter 1: The Selling-Price Formula

Every price you set should be built from five parts. Write them on a sticky note and keep it near your workspace.

- Materials: beads, thread, clasps, ear wires, chain, packaging.
- Labor: the time you spend, valued at an hourly rate you choose.
- Overhead: the small costs that are hard to attribute to one piece, such as needles, wax, tools wearing out, light and storage.
- Fees: marketplace listing and sales fees, payment processing fees, shipping supplies you do not charge for.
- Profit: the amount left for the business after everything else, which lets you grow, restock and cope with surprises.

The first three add up to your total cost. Fees and profit are best handled as percentages of the final selling price, because they grow when the price grows. That leads to the formula this guide uses throughout.

> **THE FORMULA**
> Selling price = (Materials + Labor + Overhead) divided by (1 minus fee percentage minus profit percentage).

Here is why we divide instead of simply adding a percentage on top. Suppose your total cost is $20 and you want a 15 percent profit and expect 10 percent in fees. If you just add 25 percent to the cost, you get $25. But then fees are 10 percent of $25, which is $2.50, and profit is 15 percent of $25, which is $3.75. That adds up to $6.25, more than the $5 you added, so you came out short. With the formula, $20 divided by 0.75 is $26.67. Fees are $2.67, profit is $4.00, and everything adds up exactly.

Part	How to find it	Example
Materials	Beads used plus findings plus packaging	$10.53
Labor	Hours times your hourly rate	3 h x $15 = $45.00
Overhead	Flat amount per piece, or a small percentage	$1.00
Total cost	Add the three	$56.53
Fees and profit	Choose percentages, such as 10% and 15% (variables)	25% combined
Selling price	Total cost divided by 0.75	$75.38

> **FEES ARE VARIABLES**
> The 10 percent used here is a placeholder to show the method. Marketplace, payment and shipping-label fees change often and differ by platform and country. Check current fees on the platform you use and put the real number in the formula.

Notice in the example table that labor is by far the largest part of the cost. That is normal in handmade work, and it is the part beginners most often leave out. The next chapters show how to measure each part accurately.

2. Chapter 2: Tracking Bead Costs Per Piece

Bead cost looks small on a single bead and large on a whole project, so measure it carefully. The best method is cost per gram, converted into cost per bead.

- Step 1: Note the price and weight on the tube or bag. Example: a 7.2 g tube of Delica 11/0 costs $5.60.
- Step 2: Divide price by weight. $5.60 divided by 7.2 g is about $0.78 per gram.
- Step 3: Find beads per gram. Count the beads in a small weighed sample, such as 1 gram, and write the number down. In this guide we use 140 beads per gram as an example; your beads, colors and finishes may differ, so weigh your own.
- Step 4: Divide cost per gram by beads per gram. $0.78 divided by 140 is about $0.0056 per bead (a little over half a cent).
- Step 5: Count beads in the pattern, add 10 to 15 percent for waste and dropped beads, and multiply.

Item	Example figure	How to use it
Tube price and weight	$5.60 for 7.2 g	Cost per gram: $0.78
Beads per gram	140 (weigh your own)	Cost per bead: $0.01
Beads in a design	1,500 (incl. spares)	1,500 x $0.01 = $8.33
Rarer or metallic colors	Often cost more per gram	Track each color separately

Prices vary widely between colors, finishes and sellers. Matte and opaque colors tend to cost less than precious-metal plated or specialty finishes, and larger bags cost less per gram than small tubes. For that reason, keep a small table of your most-used colors with the cost per gram of each, and update it when prices change. Prices and stock change; check before ordering.

Findings and thread are the second part of materials. Clasps, jump rings, ear wires, chain and crimps are bought in packs, so divide the pack price by the number of pieces. A pack of 20 ear-wire pairs at $12 is $0.60 per pair. A spool of thread that makes 40 bracelets costs only pennies per bracelet, but pennies count when you make many.

> KEEP A MATERIALS LOG
> Every time you restock, write down the date, item, quantity, total price and per-piece cost. Ten minutes a month keeps your numbers honest.

Do not forget the hidden materials: beading needles that bend, thread wax, glue, beading mats, packaging, cards, tissue and small boxes. Most makers handle these as overhead, which is covered in Chapter 3.

Practice task: Worksheet 2: Bead cost table

Make a table with columns: Color or finish, Brand and size, Price, Weight in grams, Cost per gram, Beads per gram (weighed), Cost per bead. Fill in five colors you use most. Use the Cost per bead column for every future project.

3. Chapter 3: Six Worked Examples in US Dollars

Now let us price six pieces end to end. The assumptions are stated openly so you can swap in your own: cost per bead of $0.01 (the Chapter 2 example), an hourly rate of $15, overhead of $1.00 per piece, fees of 10 percent and profit of 15 percent. All figures are illustrations.

Piece	Description	Size and time
Loom bracelet	12 beads wide, Delica 11/0, simple geometric pattern, clasp	About 7 inches, 3 hours
Peyote cuff	Wider peyote band with a snap or clasp	About 1 inch wide, 5 hours
Earrings (pair)	Small drops on ear wires	About 1.5 inches, 1 hour
Beaded pendant necklace	Beaded pendant on a purchased chain	About 18 inches, 4 hours
Ring	Peyote band ring	Adjustable to size, 1.5 hours
Gift set	Loom bracelet plus earrings in a gift box	4 hours total

Step one is the cost build-up: beads including spares, findings, labor and overhead.

Piece	Beads	Bead cost	Findings/pack	Materials	Labor (at $15/h)	Overhead	Total cost
Loom bracelet	1,500	$8.33	$2.20	$10.53	3.0h = $45.00	$1.00	$56.53
Peyote cuff	2,200	$12.22	$2.00	$14.22	5.0h = $75.00	$1.00	$90.22
Earrings (pair)	160	$0.89	$0.90	$1.79	1.0h = $15.00	$1.00	$17.79
Beaded pendant necklace	900	$5.00	$4.40	$9.40	4.0h = $60.00	$1.00	$70.40
Ring	300	$1.67	$0.40	$2.07	1.5h = $22.50	$1.00	$25.57
Gift set (bracelet + earrings)	1,660	$9.22	$4.90	$14.12	4.0h = $60.00	$1.00	$75.12

The gift set includes the bracelet and earrings materials plus $1.80 for a small gift box and card; its labor is the combined bracelet and earring time because each part is made separately. Step two applies the formula, dividing total cost by 0.75.

Piece	Total cost	Fees 10%	Profit 15%	Selling price	Rounded list price
Loom bracelet	$56.53	$7.54	$11.31	$75.38	$75
Peyote cuff	$90.22	$12.03	$18.04	$120.30	$120
Earrings (pair)	$17.79	$2.37	$3.56	$23.72	$24
Beaded pendant necklace	$70.40	$9.39	$14.08	$93.87	$94
Ring	$25.57	$3.41	$5.11	$34.09	$34
Gift set (bracelet + earrings)	$75.12	$10.02	$15.02	$100.16	$100

Look at the loom bracelet. Total cost is $56.53, of which $45.00 is labor. Dividing by 0.75 gives $75.38.

3. Chapter 3: Six Worked Examples in US Dollars (continued)

> **TYPICAL RANGES, NOT A PROMISE**
>
> People list similar handmade seed-bead pieces at a wide range of prices depending on design, quality, photos and audience. Look at what comparable pieces list for in your market, and treat the numbers here as examples to show the method, not as a guaranteed selling price.

A reality check is useful at this point. Compare your formula price to similar items online. If your formula price is far above comparable pieces, the question is not whether you are wrong but what you can change: your speed, your design complexity, your material costs or your target market. The next chapter shows how different hourly rates change the result.

Practice task: Worksheet 3: Price your own piece

Pick a piece you have already made. Write down every material with its cost, the actual time it took, an overhead amount, your fee percentage and profit percentage. Compute total cost, then selling price with the formula. Compare to similar pieces online.

4. Chapter 4: Hourly-Rate Scenarios

Your hourly rate is the most personal number in the formula. Some makers start at a modest rate while their speed is low, and raise it as their skill and speed grow. Others pick a target rate and design pieces that can be made fast enough to meet it. Here are the six pieces at three rates, using the same assumptions as before.

Piece	At $10/hour	At $15/hour	At $20/hour
Loom bracelet	$55.38	$75.38	$95.38
Peyote cuff	$86.96	$120.30	$153.63
Earrings (pair)	$17.05	$23.72	$30.39
Beaded pendant necklace	$67.20	$93.87	$120.53
Ring	$24.09	$34.09	$44.09
Gift set (bracelet + earrings)	$73.50	$100.16	$126.83

Notice what happens when you move from $10 to $20 an hour: the prices of time-heavy pieces such as the cuff and necklace climb steeply, while quick pieces such as earrings change less. Many makers respond by focusing on designs that look rich but are quick to make, or by making simple pieces in batches to save setup time.

- Option 1: Start at a rate you can live with. Many beginners use a lower rate while they are slow, knowing that speed rises with practice.
- Option 2: Choose a target rate, then work out how fast you must be and which designs fit that rate.
- Option 3: Use two rates: a lower one for practice pieces and a higher one for premium or custom work.
- Always time yourself. Start a timer when you pick up the needle and stop when you tie the last knot, including finishing and photos.

> **TIME INCLUDES EVERYTHING**
> The honest labor time includes threading, fixing mistakes, finishing, photographing, listing and packing. Many makers find their real time is 20 to 40 percent higher than their weaving time. Track it for a few pieces to find your own number.

There is a gentle trade-off here. A higher price may sell more slowly, and a lower price may sell faster but pay you less per hour. Neither is right or wrong; the point is to choose deliberately. Pricing below your cost is the one choice that quietly drains the hobby of its joy.

Also remember that not every hour of a business is paid hours. Time spent learning a new stitch, designing, shopping for beads and answering questions is part of running the work. Some makers fold this in by adding a small overhead percentage, often 5 to 10 percent of the cost, to every piece.

Practice task: Worksheet 4: Rate test

Take one piece and compute its selling price at three hourly rates of your choice. Write down which price feels honest, which feels too high and which feels too low, and why. Decide on a working rate for the next month.

5. Chapter 5: Wholesale Versus Retail

If a shop or boutique wants to buy your pieces in quantity, they will expect a wholesale price, which is lower than the price a customer pays. The retail shop then adds its own markup. The common rule of thumb in the jewelry and gift trade is that retail is about twice wholesale, a markup often called keystone. Some shops use 2.5 times, and some products use more or less. Treat these as concepts to understand, not rules you must follow.

> THE KEYSTONE IDEA
>
> Keystone means retail price equals 2 times wholesale price. If you sell a bracelet to a shop for $40, the shop would typically list it at around $80.

When you sell wholesale you usually save time and some fees: no photographing and listing each item for an individual customer, no marketplace fees if you sell directly, and no individual shipping. That is why your wholesale price should be your total cost plus profit, without the marketplace fee component. The table uses wholesale = total cost divided by 0.85 (15 percent profit) and compares it with retail at 2x and 2.5x, along with the direct online price from Chapter 3.

Piece	Total cost	Wholesale (cost + 15% profit)	Retail at 2x	Retail at 2.5x	Direct online price (Ch.3 formula)
Loom bracelet	$56.53	$66.51	$133.02	$166.27	$75.38
Peyote cuff	$90.22	$106.14	$212.29	$265.36	$120.30
Earrings (pair)	$17.79	$20.93	$41.86	$52.32	$23.72
Beaded pendant necklace	$70.40	$82.82	$165.65	$207.06	$93.87
Ring	$25.57	$30.08	$60.16	$75.20	$34.09
Gift set (bracelet + earrings)	$75.12	$88.38	$176.76	$220.95	$100.16

Look closely at the comparison. If a shop doubles your wholesale price, the retail price lands near your direct online price. That is a good sign: it means you can sell both ways without undercutting yourself. If your wholesale price doubled falls far below what you charge directly, you are either pricing the wholesale too low or the direct price too high.

- Set a minimum order for wholesale, such as a set number of pieces or a dollar amount, so each order is worth the packing and shipping time.
- Be consistent. Selling the same piece to a shop for less than your direct price is fine; selling it to a customer for less than the shop charges is not.
- Confirm terms in writing: payment timing, delivery, returns and who pays shipping.
- Check local rules about selling wholesale, resale certificates and sales tax. These vary by state and country, so check your own rules.

You do not have to sell wholesale at all. Many small makers sell only direct, online, at markets and to friends. This chapter is here so that if a shop does ask, you are not caught off guard.

6. Chapter 6: Marketplace and Payment Fees as Variables

Selling online brings fees. Marketplaces may charge for listings, take a percentage of each sale, and charge for payment processing; separate payment services charge their own percentages and sometimes a fixed amount per transaction. Shipping labels, packaging and promotional costs can add more. These fees change from time to time and differ by country, so this guide uses a placeholder and tells you to check current fees.

Fee type	What it usually looks like	Where to find it
Listing fee	A small fixed amount per listing, sometimes renewed	The platform's fee page (check current fees)
Transaction or sales fee	A percentage of the sale price	The platform's fee page (check current fees)
Payment processing	A percentage plus a fixed amount per sale	Your payment provider (check current fees)
Shipping	Label cost, mailer, tape, tissue, insert	Carrier rates and your own supply receipts
Sales tax	Varies by state or country; may be collected by the platform	Check your state or country rules

The simplest way to handle all of this is to add up the percentages that apply and use the total as your fee variable in the formula. Fixed per-sale amounts can be converted into a small overhead per piece by estimating your average sale.

> **WHY VARIABLES**
> If you hard-code 10 percent and the platform changes its fees, every price you set will be slightly wrong. Keep your fee percentage in one cell of your spreadsheet and update it once, and all prices recalculate.

You can see the effect of fees with a small test using the loom bracelet. At 5 percent fees and 15 percent profit, the divisor is 0.80; at 10 percent fees it is 0.75; at 15 percent fees it is 0.70.

Fee percentage	Divisor	Loom bracelet price (cost $56.53)
5%	0.80	$70.67
10%	0.75	$75.38
15%	0.70	$80.76

Decide whether to charge shipping separately or include it in the price. Many shoppers like clear shipping charges; others like a free-shipping price. If you offer free shipping, add the average shipping cost to your costs and price accordingly. Keep every receipt, and consider speaking with a local tax professional about records and obligations.

Practice task: Worksheet 6: Fee table

Write the platforms you sell on or may sell on. For each, record listing fee, sales fee percentage, payment fee percentage and fixed fee per sale, with the date you checked. Add the percentages to get your fee variable.

7. Chapter 7: Discounts, Bundles and Price Psychology

Once your base prices are sound, small tactics can help shoppers say yes without eroding your income. The key is to protect your floor, which is the lowest price at which a piece still pays your time and costs.

> KNOW YOUR FLOOR
> Floor price = total cost divided by (1 minus fee percentage). It covers materials, labor, overhead and fees with zero profit. Never go below it.

Piece	Total cost	Floor price at 10% fees	List price	Room for discount
Loom bracelet	$56.53	$62.81	$75	$12.19
Peyote cuff	$90.22	$100.25	$120	$19.75
Earrings (pair)	$17.79	$19.77	$24	$4.23
Beaded pendant necklace	$70.40	$78.22	$94	$15.78
Ring	$25.57	$28.41	$34	$5.59
Gift set (bracelet + earrings)	$75.12	$83.47	$100	$16.53

Discounts. A modest, occasional discount, such as a small percentage for a first order or a seasonal sale, is fine as long as the price stays above your floor. Constant discounts teach shoppers to wait. A better approach is to keep list prices steady and offer value instead of cuts.

Bundles. Bundles raise the average order. A bracelet and earrings in a gift box feel like a present, and the buyer saves the effort of choosing. In our examples, selling the gift set costs you only a small amount more in extra packaging while earning the profit of two pieces.

- Matching sets: earrings plus bracelet in one color story, priced a little below buying separately.
- Multi-buy: a small saving for two or three of the same item, ideal for simple pieces like rings.
- Gift-ready: add a card and box and charge for it, since packaging is a cost.
- Custom colors: charge a small extra for personalized color choices, since they take planning time.

Price psychology. Some well-known patterns are worth knowing, as long as you stay honest and clear.

- Prices ending in 5 or 9 can look friendlier, while round numbers can feel more premium. Test which suits your style.
- Offering three tiers, such as simple, standard and premium, helps buyers compare and often leads to the middle choice.
- Show an anchor: a larger, more expensive piece makes the next one look reasonable.
- Good photos and clear descriptions support your price more than any trick.
- Avoid fake sales and invented original prices. Be truthful about discounts.

Practice task: Worksheet 7: Floor and ceiling

8. Chapter 8: When to Raise Prices, and the One-Page Cheat Sheet

Many makers wait too long to raise prices. Here are signs that it might be time, in no particular order.

- You have sold out of a piece quickly, more than once.
- Your costs have gone up: beads, findings, fees or shipping.
- Your speed or quality has improved, and your designs are now more refined.
- You have a waiting list or repeat customers asking for more.
- You are working hours that no longer feel worth it at the current price.

How to raise gently: change prices on new listings first, raise by a small step rather than a big jump, and avoid announcing it with an apology. Existing customers usually understand that handmade work costs more over time. Many makers review prices every few months or at the start of each season.

Now bring everything together. Print this page and keep it by your workspace.

Step	What to do	Example
1. Bead cost	Price divided by weight, divided by beads per gram	$5.60 / 7.2 g / 140 = $0.0056 per bead
2. Count	Beads in the pattern plus 10-15% spares	1,500 beads
3. Findings	Pack price divided by pieces in pack	$12 / 20 pairs = $0.60
4. Labor	Timed hours (all steps) times hourly rate	3 h x $15 = $45.00
5. Overhead	Flat amount or small percentage	$1.00
6. Total cost	Materials + labor + overhead	See Chapter 3
7. Fees	Check current fees; add percentages	10% (variable)
8. Profit	Choose a percentage	15%
9. Price	Total cost / (1 - fees - profit)	Total cost / 0.75
10. Wholesale	Total cost / (1 - profit); retail about 2x to 2.5x	See Chapter 5
11. Floor	Total cost / (1 - fees)	Never go below
12. Review	Compare with similar pieces; adjust every season	Update fees and bead costs

KEEP IT SIMPLE

If the whole process feels heavy, start with just three numbers: total cost, floor price and list price. You can refine the rest as you go.

Practice task: Worksheet 8: Your pricing sheet

Create a one-page spreadsheet with a row per piece and these columns: Piece, Beads, Bead cost, Findings, Materials, Hours, Hourly rate, Labor, Overhead, Total cost, Fee %, Profit %, Selling price, Floor price, Wholesale, Retail 2x. Put Fee %, Profit % and hourly rate in single cells at the top so every row updates when you change them.

Next steps

Pricing is a skill, and like any skill it improves with practice. The formula is simple: materials, labor, overhead, fees and profit. The hard part is being honest about your time and your costs, and kind enough to yourself to charge for both.

Start with one piece. Weigh your beads, time yourself, fill in the worksheet, and compute a price. Compare it with similar pieces, adjust, and write down what you decided. Then do the next piece. In a few weeks you will have a pricing sheet that you trust.

Remember that every figure in this guide is an example. Your beads, your speed and your market are your own. Keep your numbers current, check fees and your local rules, and let your prices grow with your skill.

Price worksheet · Loom bracelet

Fill in once per design, then reuse the numbers for every color variation.

Line	$
Beads (grams or count × cost)	
Thread, needle, findings	
Packaging (box, card, bag)	
Materials subtotal	
Time (hours) × your hourly rate	
Marketplace / payment fees (check current)	
Overhead share (supplies, tools, photos)	
Total cost	
Profit margin you want	
Retail price (rounded)	
Wholesale price (≈ half of retail)	

CHECK

Does the final price feel fair for the time you spent? If not, raise the price, simplify the design, or speed up your process.

Price worksheet · Peyote cuff

Fill in once per design, then reuse the numbers for every color variation.

Line	$
Beads (grams or count × cost)	
Thread, needle, findings	
Packaging (box, card, bag)	
Materials subtotal	
Time (hours) × your hourly rate	
Marketplace / payment fees (check current)	
Overhead share (supplies, tools, photos)	
Total cost	
Profit margin you want	
Retail price (rounded)	
Wholesale price (≈ half of retail)	

CHECK

Does the final price feel fair for the time you spent? If not, raise the price, simplify the design, or speed up your process.

Price worksheet · Earrings

Fill in once per design, then reuse the numbers for every color variation.

Line	$
Beads (grams or count × cost)	
Thread, needle, findings	
Packaging (box, card, bag)	
Materials subtotal	
Time (hours) × your hourly rate	
Marketplace / payment fees (check current)	
Overhead share (supplies, tools, photos)	
Total cost	
Profit margin you want	
Retail price (rounded)	
Wholesale price (≈ half of retail)	

CHECK

Does the final price feel fair for the time you spent? If not, raise the price, simplify the design, or speed up your process.

Price worksheet · Pendant necklace

Fill in once per design, then reuse the numbers for every color variation.

Line	$
Beads (grams or count × cost)	
Thread, needle, findings	
Packaging (box, card, bag)	
Materials subtotal	
Time (hours) × your hourly rate	
Marketplace / payment fees (check current)	
Overhead share (supplies, tools, photos)	
Total cost	
Profit margin you want	
Retail price (rounded)	
Wholesale price (≈ half of retail)	

CHECK

Does the final price feel fair for the time you spent? If not, raise the price, simplify the design, or speed up your process.

Price worksheet · Ring band

Fill in once per design, then reuse the numbers for every color variation.

Line	$
Beads (grams or count × cost)	
Thread, needle, findings	
Packaging (box, card, bag)	
Materials subtotal	
Time (hours) × your hourly rate	
Marketplace / payment fees (check current)	
Overhead share (supplies, tools, photos)	
Total cost	
Profit margin you want	
Retail price (rounded)	
Wholesale price (≈ half of retail)	

CHECK

Does the final price feel fair for the time you spent? If not, raise the price, simplify the design, or speed up your process.

Price worksheet · Gift set

Fill in once per design, then reuse the numbers for every color variation.

Line	$
Beads (grams or count × cost)	
Thread, needle, findings	
Packaging (box, card, bag)	
Materials subtotal	
Time (hours) × your hourly rate	
Marketplace / payment fees (check current)	
Overhead share (supplies, tools, photos)	
Total cost	
Profit margin you want	
Retail price (rounded)	
Wholesale price (≈ half of retail)	

CHECK

Does the final price feel fair for the time you spent? If not, raise the price, simplify the design, or speed up your process.